Studio report: Queensland University of Technology

Andrew Brown

Queensland University of Technology
Victoria Park Rd.
Kelvin Grove, 4059. Australia

a.brown@qut.edu.au

Abstract

he last 12 months have been a busy one for music at QUT. There have been numerous concerts and CDs created by students and staff, including Andy Arthurs' (HOD) compositions for the Queensland Theatre Company productions. Students continue to play regularly in Brisbane clubs and the alternative electronic music scene has grown rapidly with regular concerts at the new Powerhouse Centre for Live Arts and many events organised by Brisbane artists such as Andrew Kettle and Michael Norris in which staff and students of QUT regularly participate. We have been commissioned to do the web site sound design for this years Brisbane Festival of Music. The electronic music ensemble Simulation are touring to this conference and then to Melbourne for performances as part of our expanding emphasis on the integration of live performance and music technologies.

We continue to have strong demand for the undergraduate program and next year will expand to offer two new degrees in addition to the Bachelor of Music in Intermedia Arts and Sound Design. The former focussing on combining visual arts and music and the latter on IT, Multimedia and
Music. These changes are part of a wider shift in QUT structure with the introduction of the Faculty of Creative Industries of which music is a part.

The post graduate area has been growing and we have seen a four-fold increase in post graduate numbers (from a low base) over the past year. A significant contributor to that is the REV project (Real, Electronic and Virtual Instrument design, composition and performance). This postgraduate project focuses on elecronic and cyber instruments including software design and will culminate in a two week REV Festival in Brisbane around Easter 2002, in which we encourage all instrument makers to participate.

Our research activities continue to centre around instrument making and using (in the broadest sense). The jMusic environment continues to expand with added facilities for real time audio, JavaSound MIDI support, XML reading and writing, and peer to peer networking capabilities added or significantly expanded in the past year. jMusic is being used as the basis for an online music tools project in conjunction with Education Queensland to deliver computer music making facilities via the world wide web. Our new faculty structure has resulted in a new research centre being established, the Creative Industries Research and Applications Centre (CIRAC) and this centre is supporting the above research projects with staff and teaching relief this year.

We look forward to continued growth inthe post graduate area, finding ways to further work with interested parties in the Brisbane music community and beyond, and to generate new work and knowledge through our research efforts. The past twelve months have been productive, and the next year looks just as exciting for music at QUT.